with me, and she was dozing off, but I just lay there, wide awake ... midnight ... 2 am ... For a moment, I thought I heard raised voices in the hotel reception. Were they keeping me up? It was 4 am ... 6 am ... And then, all of a sudden, it was time to gather my things and join the rest of the squad on the bus to Kingsmead.

This is bizarre, I thought. I am going to play a Test and I have literally not slept for one minute. I was hoping we would bat, so I could maybe get a quick nap in the dressing room, but MS Dhoni won the toss and decided India would bat first, so we were fielding and I was keeping wicket, which meant I needed to concentrate for every single ball of what, in all probability, was going to be a long and demanding day.

I felt totally exhausted. How would I survive? I was beginning to panic. Calm down, I told myself; take it ball by ball, over by over. I got by. India reached 76 for one at lunch, and I walked straight off the field, into the changing room and slept for 25 minutes of the 40-minute interval. I managed to get through the afternoon as well and, with the Indians 163 for one at tea, lay down and slept for 10 minutes of the 20-minute break.

Mercifully, bad light forced an early close after just eight overs of the evening session, and I was hugely relieved to get back to the hotel, get something to eat and get a proper night's sleep. It had been a troubling experience, but I recovered the next day and took five catches as India were bowled out for 334.

'Just take a sleeping pill.'

That was Mike Hussey's advice several months later when we were chatting during the IPL. The Australian is one of the kindest, wisest and most sensible cricketers I have met, and he explained how he would take a pill before major matches just to make sure he slept well and was properly prepared.

I discussed the matter with my father, a GP, and he assured me it should be fine to take half a sleeping pill every now and then. So that's what I do, and the drama of Durban has not been repeated.